

Board: 1

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 4♥

Declarer: North

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ Q 8 3 2

♥ K Q 10

♦ 10 8 3

♣ Q 7 5

♠ K 5

♥ A 9 4 3

♦ A 6 4

♣ A 9 8 2



♠ J 10 7

♥ J 5

♦ Q J 9 2

♣ J 10 4 3

♠ A 9 6 4

♥ 8 7 6 2

♦ K 7 5

♣ K 6

West

North

East

South

1NT

Pass

2♣

Pass

2♥

Pass

4♥

All Pass

4♥ by North

assumes that trumps break 3-2, (if they don't you cannot make it), and also assumes you will be able to cross-ruff 4 small black cards.

With 10 points and two 4-card Majors you bid 2♣ Stayman. Partner says 2♥;

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Now you add a point for your doubleton, get to 11 points, and bid 4♥.

The contract would be 4♥ played by South.

North plays 4♥. East leads the ♦Q. Win the ♦Q in either hand. Lets say you win with your ♦A.

Loser List: ♠ = 0 : ♥ = 2* : ♦ = 1 : ♣ = 0 :: Total = 3*

*Don't get overconfident with this loser list. It

Cross-ruffing those 4 losers could be a problem. You can't afford to get over-ruffed so it would be nice if you could pull some trumps before you start the cross-ruff. But you must make sure that only two rounds of trumps get pulled, otherwise you won't have the trumps for the cross-ruff.

It is actually simple to make sure exactly two rounds of trumps are drawn. At trick 2 just duck a ♥ in each hand. An opponent will win this, but you can take the next trick, (probably a ♦), and then pull a second round of trumps with your ♥A. Then leave the trumps alone and play your two black A K's, then start cross-ruffing with your 4 tiny trumps. The defender with the master trump can over-ruff when he can, and can even cash a ♦. But that's all he can do so you will make your game.

Suppose you had played first the ♥A, then a small ♥.

West would have won the second one, and if he had then continued ♦s you would have made the contract.

But if he was a good enough defender to pull a THIRD round of trumps, getting 2 for the price of 1 value, you would have been defeated.